



THE UOS TIMES

University of Sharjah's Student Lab Newspaper

Issue #17 | November 2025 | Fall Recap | Campus Life | Fashion

University of Sharjah Ranks 47th in Research Quality Worldwide: An Inside Look With Dr. Yousef Haik, Vice Chancellor of Academic Affairs



Credit: Haaniyah Memon

HIGHLIGHTS FROM THIS MONTH'S OPINION PIECES

Your Dreams are in English, Aren't They?

An exploration of how the global dominance of English acts as a modern form of colonization, shaping how people think, and speak.

Page # 6

By Mira Fadi

The New Age of Activism

Examines how modern activism has become performative, often reduced to reposts and online gestures rather than real action.

Page # 12

By Adam Ismail

Moments & Memoirs

Moments & memoirs is a space dedicated to personal stories and reflections, where writers share snapshots of life that are meaningful, memorable, or transformative.

Page # 12,13,14

By Mustafa & Sarah

Where Did Literacy Go?

A discussion on how modern society has shifted from deep, meaningful reading to surface-level digital consumption.

Page # 11

By Haaniyah Memon

The Lost Art of...

A deep dive on the changes of society and social norms.

Page # 16

By Yassmin & Intesar Khalil

The Sharjah International Book Fair Opens Its Doors For Another Successful Year

The University of Sharjah has ranked 47th in Research Quality and 3rd in International Outlook according to the 2026 Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings, reinforcing its continuous progress across various rankings.

By Muniba Saeed

The Sharjah International Book Fair Opens Its Doors For Another Successful Year



Credit: Gulf News

The Builders of AlHambra : Film Screening and One-on-One with Director Isabel Fernández



Credit: University Of Sharjah

Constructores de la Alhambra), followed by a discussion with its director and producer, Ms. Isabel Fernández. Page # 2

By Leen Moufleh

On October 23rd 2025, the University of Sharjah hosted an exclusive screening of the documentary The Builders of the Alhambra (Los

THE SHARJAH INTERNATIONAL BOOK FAIR OPENS ITS DOORS FOR ANOTHER EXCITING YEAR

November 6th 2025

By: Batool Maher

The Sharjah International Book Fair is back this year for its yearly reign in Sharjah's intellectual hub. It is from 5th November to 16th November 2025, with the opening hours from Sunday to Wednesday at 10:00- 22:00 and Thursday- Saturday: 10:00- 23:00, with Friday from 16:00- 23:00. There will be shuttle buses that connect Dubai and Sharjah to transport visitors, and parking will be available at Al Qasba, Sharjah Aquarium, and Expo Centre.

The Sharjah International Book Fair, or SIBF for short, is a cultural and literary hub of the region. It is one of the world's largest book fairs, held at the Sharjah Expo Centre, and has over 400 literary events. It includes workshops like writing, poetry reading, and book signings. The event attracts over 2 million visitors and 1,400+ national and international publishing houses.

It was established in 1982 by H.H. Sheikh Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, the Ruler of Sharjah. It has crossed over 50 million in sales and connects authors and publishers from all over the globe to read, discuss trends, and foster opportunities together. SIBF has been awarded memberships to various international organizations, like the Afro-Asian Publishers' Association, and has been recognized by the International Publishers' Association.



Credit: Gulf News

be, highlighted by Ahmed bin Rakkad Al Ameri, CEO of the Sharjah Book Authority, when he said: "Every reader's interaction with the written word becomes part of their own life story, revealing who they are and the world they carry within."

As for the guest of honor, it is Greece, celebrating its long history of literature, philosophy, and art. To do this, SIBF will showcase 600 titles from 58 Greek publishers, 70 Greek participants, including writers and illustrators. "We invite visitors to explore the richness of Greek language, thought, and art," said Panagiotis Kougiou, Chargé d'Affaires at the Greek Embassy in the UAE.

Their website provides information on how to apply and become an exhibitor, as well as how to represent a publisher. It also offers jobs for young people to work as salespeople and provides them with the opportunity to build their resume.

One of the many incredible activities the book fair offers is that it hosts book readings and learning activities for children. This allows children to foster a love for books at a young age and grow their attitude towards reading in a positive direction.

One of the visitors, Leen Mazen, a 16-year-old with a love for reading, thinks that people should visit it despite not being into reading because it is nice to be surrounded by books:

"You're not surrounded by books every day; it gives you a new perspective. I discovered my love for reading right here as a kid; it can foster that."

The Sharjah International Book Fair is a prominent event in the history of Sharjah and is designed to enrich the visitors of all ages and nationalities. It is a great way to spend the afternoon, surrounded by a hub of literature and art, exploring different genres and learning new things, so make sure you do not miss out on it this year!



Credit: Gulf News

THE BUILDERS OF ALHAMBRA: FILM SCREENING AND ONE-ON-ONE WITH DIRECTOR ISABEL FERNANDEZ

October 23rd 2025

By: Leen Moufleh

On October 23rd 2025, the University of Sharjah hosted an exclusive screening of the documentary *The Builders of the Alhambra* (Los Constructores de la Alhambra), followed by a discussion with its director and producer, Ms. Isabel Fernández. Following the event, a one-on-one interview was conducted with Ms. Fernández to further explore her experience as a female filmmaker and the creative process behind the documentary film.

The documentary *The Builders of the Alhambra* highlights Yusuf I of Granada, the 14th-century Nasrid ruler who commissioned and supervised much of the Alhambra Palace. Portrayed by the talented Karim Saidi, Yusuf I is depicted as a visionary leader and patron of art whose legacy shaped one of the world's most iconic monuments. Under Isabel Fernández's direction and production, the film humanizes the Sultan, revealing the intellect and creativity behind the careful curation and building of Alhambra's grandeur architecture.

In the interview conducted with Ms. Fernández, she discussed her perspective as a woman in a field that remains largely male-dominated. She explained the challenges many female filmmakers face in gaining support and funding for their projects.

“When a woman wants to be a director, most of the time she ends up becoming a producer,” Fernández stated. “It’s very difficult to convince producers — most of them men — to believe in your project. So, like many women, I decided to be my own producer to push my work forward.”

She emphasized that many women enter the production side of the industry out of necessity, in order to maintain control and ensure their projects are realized. Fernández noted that learning the business side of filmmaking — from budgeting to production logistics — is essential for directors who wish to work independently.

The documentary itself took seven years to complete, a process Fernández described as technically and logistically complex. One of the most significant challenges was securing permission to film inside the Alhambra, a site that rarely allows cinema crews access.

“It was incredibly difficult,” she explained. “The Alhambra has very strict regulations. We had to invent specific solutions to film with cinema cameras and actors without damaging the site. Every step required negotiation and creativity.”

This was the first time a production of this scale was given the authority to shoot within the Alhambra. Fernández's team used specialized equipment and developed filming techniques to comply with the preservation standards of the historical monument.

Despite extensive challenges, the film maintains a strong focus on the human and artistic spirit that shaped the Alhambra's construction. Through its storytelling and exploration of Sufi themes of divine love, spiritual enlightenment, and the quest for union with God, *The Builders of the Alhambra* highlights the intricate relationship between creativity, craftsmanship, and inter-religious exchange.

When asked about how she hopes to be remembered as a filmmaker, Fernández's answer reflected a broader perspective about the enduring nature of art.

“I don’t think of being remembered,” she said. “What matters is that the art lives on. If something I’ve created can touch people’s hearts, spark imagination, or inspire thought, then that’s enough. That’s the goal.”

Her remarks align with the film's central theme — that art and architecture outlive their creators, continuing to inspire generations long after their time.

The Builders of the Alhambra serves as an ode to the original builders of the monument and to contemporary creators who dedicate years of effort to preserving and interpreting history through art. It celebrates a period where Islamic art and design shaped Andalusian civilization. Furthermore, the interview with Ms. Isabel Fernández offered valuable insight into the experiences of an independent filmmaker and woman in the field, highlighting the challenges she endured throughout the creative process.

UOS RANKS 47TH IN RESEARCH QUALITY WORLDWIDE

AN INSIDE LOOK WITH DR. YOUSEF HAIK, VICE CHANCELLOR OF ACADEMIC AFFAIRS

October 12, 2025

By: Muniba Saeed

The University of Sharjah has ranked 47th in Research Quality and 3rd in International Outlook according to the 2026 Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings, reinforcing its continuous progress across various rankings including QS World University Rankings, and the U.S. News Global University Rankings.

“In the Times Higher Education ranking, the University’s research quality indicator has shown continuous improvement ... This achievement highlights the University’s strategic emphasis on high-impact research, international collaboration, and faculty excellence,” said Dr. Yousef Haik, the Vice Chancellor of Academic Affairs.

Over the past few years, the University has built its reputation as a leading center for research by placing an emphasis on high-impact research, faculty excellence, and collaboration across borders.

Dr. Haik mentioned several factors—such as research strategies focused on global challenges, investment in research infrastructure and support, strong international partnerships and commitment to fostering a vibrant scholarly community—have contributed to the University’s success in the rankings.

The University of Sharjah has continuously fostered an academic environment that integrates quality research with the learning experience by providing support for research initiatives, competitive internal grants, interdisciplinary research centers and advanced lab facilities.

“Several research areas at the University of Sharjah have achieved international distinction in recent rankings,” added Dr. Haik. “... the University’s performance has been particularly strong in Engineering, Business and Economics, Physical Sciences, and Computer Science, all of which were ranked within the 201–250 global band.”

According to Dr. Haik, one of the challenges that remains is sustaining the momentum and impact while still “expanding the scope of interdisciplinary collaboration.” To address this, the University has developed a strategy that places importance on the impact of the research and initiatives that “translate knowledge into tangible societal and economic benefits.”

“By promoting international collaboration and knowledge transfer, the University ensures that its research has global relevance and measurable impact, reinforcing its role as a key contributor to the UAE’s vision of a knowledge-based economy and to the advancement of humanity at large.”

Dr. Haik also highlighted the role of start-ups arising from faculty and student research and international collaborations in improving the University’s global ranking. There is also an alignment toward areas relevant nationally and internationally, including renewable energy, environmental sustainability, advanced materials, health sciences, artificial intelligence, and smart technologies.

“By promoting international collaboration and knowledge transfer, the University ensures that its research has global relevance and measurable impact, reinforcing its role as a key contributor to the UAE’s vision of a knowledge-based economy and to the advancement of humanity at large.”

This aim is highlighted in the University’s partnership with the Sharjah National Oil Corporation (SNOC) to advance research in energy, water and the environment. The University also hosted the 5th Forum for women in research, awarding more than 40 grants across 4 categories, honoring exceptional female researchers.

Building on these milestones, the University of Sharjah plans to expand its research networks aiming to position the University among the top 200 universities globally within the next few years.

“By nurturing an ecosystem that connects research excellence with innovation and community service, the University of Sharjah is well positioned to sustain and enhance its trajectory in global rankings.”



QISKAT FALL FEST 2025

October 30th 2025

By: Razan Abdullah and Mawada Issam

On October 30–31, the University of Sharjah's Male Forum transformed into a hub of futuristic ideas and curiosity as students gathered for Qiskat Fall Fest — the university's first-ever event dedicated to quantum computing. Held from 2:00 PM to 5:00 PM, the event aimed to open the doors of one of the world's most groundbreaking and evolving fields to the UOS community.

Organized by the Google Developer Groups (GDG) Club at UOS, a student-led community under the college of IT & Informatics, the event united students, professors, and industry experts with one mission: to spark interest in the science redefining the future of technology.

With hands-on activities, interactive booths, and expert-led talks, the forum buzzed with excitement and ambition. Laptops hummed as students explored simulations and demos that translated complex theories into real-world ideas.

Quantum computing — once a topic reserved for advanced researchers — is now gaining attention across academia and industry. Its potential to revolutionize areas like cybersecurity, medicine, and artificial intelligence makes it one of the most influential emerging fields today. At UOS, students experienced that world up close for the first time.



Credit: Razan Abdullah
Kirill Vysukov, Technical Leader at (GDG) Club and Lead Organizer

The sessions featured a talk by Dr. Ahmad Al-Qatatsheh from IBM Quantum — one of the world's leading organizations in the field — who provided an inside look into the evolution of quantum technology, followed by Professor Qassim Nasir from the University of Sharjah, who introduced the fundamentals in a clear and student-friendly way. On the second day, the program expanded even further with guest speakers Dr. Amaria Javed and Dr. Nouhaila Innan from NYU Abu Dhabi and the Technology Innovation Institute (TII) Dr. Juan Villegas who explored foundational concepts, superconductive circuit design, and emerging applications in quantum machine learning. Across the two days, this multi-layered academic program offered students both accessible entry-level explanations and forward-looking insights into the future of the field.

Rather than overwhelming attendees with complex theories, the talks focused on building awareness and understanding. “It wasn’t too technical,” Kirill explained. “The goal was simply to help students understand the basics and get familiar with the field.”

Omar Muhammad Farouk, President of the GDG Club, highlighted the event's significance. “This is the first quantum-focused event at the University of Sharjah, and it may even be the first in the UAE,” he shared. “It’s important for us to introduce students to cutting-edge areas of computing and spark their curiosity.”



Credit: Razan Abdullah
Omar Muhammad Farouk, President of Google Developer Groups (GDG).

For Omar, it was about more than education — it was about excitement and community. “We want students to enjoy themselves but also explore new areas,” he said. “The speakers gave resources so they can continue learning and start their journey in this field.”

Many attendees left inspired — including students outside the computing field. “I always thought quantum computing was something only scientists could understand,” said Clinical Nutrition and Dietetics student Taquwa Kamis Gaballah. “But after attending the talks, it feels much more approachable — and I actually want to learn more.”

Behind the scenes, organizing the event required dedication and teamwork. “Planning was hectic — contacting speakers, waiting for responses — but once everything came together, it ran smoothly,” Kirill said. Omar echoed his appreciation, noting that “with the support of the college and professors like Dr. Manar, we’re able to bring these ideas to life. This is already our third event this semester, and we definitely plan to continue hosting more tech-focused activities in the future, Inshallah.”

Qiskat Fall Fest marks a turning point for tech-driven engagement at UOS. It showcased the university's commitment to innovation, knowledge, and empowering students with the tools needed for tomorrow's opportunities.

Events like these remind us that innovation doesn't just happen in labs — it begins with curiosity, collaboration, and community.

YOUR DREAMS ARE IN ENGLISH, ARE'NT THEY?

November 1st 2025

By Mira Fadi

You think in English, text in English, argue in English, and yet, it's not even your language. We are living in an age where the English language surrounds us from every side, quite literally submerging us. Our thoughts, jokes, inner monologues, and even our dreams, are in English. We slowly forget our mother tongue, struggling to recall simple words. When asked what our native language is, we hesitate to answer because our second language has become more prominent than our first.

English originally spread through colonization, military power, and war. Today, it's a silent killer of culture and local languages, spreading through the very content we choose to consume on a daily basis: every scroll, song, and movie. Even when watching a show or a movie in our native language, English subtitles have become the norm. It is now the most spoken language in the world, not because it was anyone's first, but because it became everyone's second.

Language doesn't just communicate thoughts, it shapes perceptions. When you speak in English, you're not just borrowing words, but also the culture, humor, and worldview that comes along with them. It's similar to switching identities. The way we express emotions like saying "I'm fine," "I'm sad", or "I'm happy" sounds different than when we say them in our native tongue. It feels distant, less expressive, and less passionate. Some words simply don't exist in English, one's that carry feelings and understanding that no translation can capture, making them making ideas "untranslatable," words that carry feelings and understanding that no translation can capture.

The loss of nuance isn't limited to words alone, even the way we speak, our accents and dialects, are erased by the dominance of English. Speaking with a noticeable accent or dialect is often condemned as "unprofessional" or "less educated," even when the speaker is fluent. Over time, people replace the little rhythms, sounds, and quirks tied to their identity with a standardized, widely accepted version to fit in. A "western" accent is praised while others are mocked. Originality slowly fades, and with it, who we are and where we come from. Yet, people try to adapt and maintain elements of their origins through code-switching, mixing English with their native language, or using hybrid languages like Arabish or Hinglish, in hopes to maintain their identity without completely letting go of their roots.

English is power and privilege. Achieving its fluency is now equivalent to social status, intelligence, and success. The inability to speak English is an immediate disadvantage and a lack of credibility, considering everything revolves around it. Job opportunities, education, and social discussions are immersed by English

It is the language of science, technology, and academia. People who struggle with it aren't dealing with a minor inconvenience; they are often excluded, overlooked, and sidelined. English has become a prerequisite to access global knowledge and it's what decides who belongs and who doesn't. It has become the common ground for communication

"The domination of a people's language by the languages of the colonizing nations was crucial to the domination of the mental universe of the colonized."

People who struggle with it aren't dealing with a minor inconvenience; they are often excluded, overlooked, and sidelined. English has become a prerequisite to access global knowledge and it's what decides who belongs and who doesn't. It has become the common ground for communication where people who don't share a native language often default to English to be understood. Many dedicate their time and resources to learning and perfecting their understanding and knowledge of English, often at the expense of preserving their own customs and culture.

Living in an English-dominated world rewires our brains, adapting to the language we use, see, and hear the most. Sometimes words come out more naturally in English than our native language. It's convenient and faster, subtly shaping what feels "natural" or "right" to say. It's not that we love English more, it's that it's become the language our minds find comfort in. How many times have you caught yourself frantically searching for the translate button because your brain now comprehends English better than your own language?

We are living in a state of modern colonization. English dominates our minds, conversations, and opportunities. It decides who belongs, who succeeds, and who is sidelined. However, we have the choice to either let it erase who we are, or to complement the parts of our language, culture, and identity that English can never fully capture, so that maybe we can start thinking, feeling, and dreaming in our own language.

THE CLASS OF RESILIENCE: HOW GEN Z STUDENTS ARE NAVIGATING A TOUGH MARKET

November 1st 2025

By: Muniba Saeed

As the UAE job market grows increasingly competitive, students and recent graduates are adapting by turning to freelancing, networking, and side projects to improve employability. While new job openings remain strong, recruiters have become more selective, and automated resume screenings now filter out a majority of applicants, preventing them from making it to a human review.

Government and corporate initiatives such as Emiratization, which prioritizes UAE nationals for certain roles, add another layer of competition for expatriate job seekers. Despite these challenges, the UAE continues to report steady hiring rates, particularly for candidates with specialized or niche expertise. However, automation and artificial intelligence are changing the nature of available work. A study by job search website Adzuna found that entry-level vacancies and junior roles have fallen by about a third since ChatGPT's launch in November 2022.

"Globally, the unemployment rate for recent college graduates has risen by 30 per cent since late 2022, compared to an 18 per cent increase for the general workforce. Yet the UAE's proactive labour policies and commitment to workforce development appear to be cushioning these effects," said Najat Abdalhadi, career expert at LinkedIn.

"The challenge now is to ensure that this momentum translates into building the sustainable human skills that the world of work will always need, such as creative thinking, strategic problem-solving, and cross-functional collaboration," she said. "In doing so, the UAE could become a model for how to navigate AI disruption without sidelining the next generation of talent."

According to Adecco's senior vice-president, "Rather than displacing these roles entirely, AI is automating repetitive tasks, allowing professionals to focus more on judgment, creativity, and human interaction," adding that "human + machine collaboration is the new norm."

For Maseera Haddadi, a BBA student pursuing a diploma in AI, ML, and Data Analytics, the job search has been difficult but enlightening. "Job hunting is tough, but I am learning new skills and being hopeful of landing a job," she said. Maseera is seeking entry-level roles or internships in data analytics and machine learning but noted that "job descriptions require 2-3 years' experience, master's and senior level technical skills."

She admits that while her degree offered "great insights of the business world with real life experience," Haddadi said it didn't make her job prepared when comparing to the job market requirements. She added that she is "actively networking with relevant field events, seminars/webinars," and working on projects to "develop my technical skills and to be able to

represent what I have learned." She said access to mentorship and exposure to industry challenges could have better prepared her for current demands.

Zoha Nasir, an architecture student who also works in graphic design, said freelancing has been key to gaining experience. "Honestly, my job search experience has been quite a journey," she said. After months of rejections, she secured a paid internship by uploading her CV across multiple platforms.

She described challenges including low pay and unpaid offers. "Many opportunities were either unpaid or offered very little pay ... even though I already have relevant experience."

Zoha credited her architecture studies for preparing her well, saying, "Our professors are very industry-focused and push us to produce realistic, precise, and high-quality work." Networking, leadership roles, and learning AI tools have also helped her stand out. "Learning to adapt quickly and stay updated with technology especially AI is key," she said.

As automation reshapes the corporate world and competition intensifies, UAE students are increasingly blending education with digital skills, freelance experience, and professional networks—a strategy that is redefining the next generation of job seekers.

"Learning to adapt quickly and stay updated with technology especially AI is key. The job market changes constantly, and those who can blend creativity with new tech skills as in be adaptable are the ones who truly stand out."
- Zoha Nasir

Campus Couture

Written by Intesar & Yassmin Mohammed Khalil

It's the busiest time of the semester and with everyone racing to meet deadlines, Campus Couture is back to give you a short break. From standout looks on campus to verdicts on trends, this issue we're back with something new, Trend History, because fashion isn't just what's hot right now, it's also a timeline that connects the past to the present.

Trend History: *Function to Fashion*

In a place devoted to learning, it only feels right to study the history of fashion itself. Take a step back in time and uncover the origins of a few beloved trends that now stride confidently across campus.



Source: Cross Sword blog

Heels, long before they clicked through lecture halls, didn't begin in women's wardrobes. They first appeared in 10th-century Persia, worn by male soldiers who needed extra grip in their stirrups. Later, European nobility adopted them as symbols of power and prestige. By the 18th century, though, men's heels had flattened while women's reached new heights making a fashionable change of command.



Source: Vintage Dancer

has now become one of style. But heels aren't the only ones to change syllabus. In the 19th century, Levi Strauss and Jacob Davis took a sturdy cotton fabric called serge de Nîmes and turned it into something revolutionary: the first pair of riveted blue jeans. Built for miners and laborers, denim was made to last through anything. Fast-forward to today, it dominates student wardrobe from jeans to jackets, with many

personalized by pins and patches. What was once built for hard work now provides comfort and style to students.

Then, of course, there is the trench coat, born in the mud and rain of World War I, perfected at the hands of British brands like Burberry and Aquascutum. Originally designed for soldiers who needed something durable and to protect them from the harsh weather in the trenches (hence the name). The coat balanced practicality with quiet authority, due to its belts, storm flaps, and sharp tailoring. When the war was over, it did not fade away; designers reimagined it for everyday wear. Now, the sharp tailoring and timeless cut makes even the simplest outfit a statement of sophistication on campus hallways.



Source: Heddels

Campus Fit Check

As deadlines pile up, stress levels are sky high and caffeine has become everyone's best friend. But some still manage to stand out in the middle of all the rush. After all, fashion always finds its moment!

Shouq Al Ali - *International Relations Student*

Edgy, classy and extra are the three words Shouq uses to describe her style. She defines comfort as wearing what she likes and says, "I wear heels ALL the time, it could be painful to some but it's comfort to me." For her go-to outfit, she opts for simplicity by wearing jeans and a shirt and uses eye makeup to

Shouq's fashion advice:
"Jewellery and accessories make everything prettier and more elegant, you can wear the most simple and basic fit but adding jewellery or accessories will make you pop!"



add a pop of color to her look. When asked about how she plans her outfits, Shouq says, "I have a mannequin at home and I usually plan my fits the night before, but sometimes I can't decide so I just wait for the next day for my mood to decide!" She uses chain belts or long necklaces to add a little

touch to her look and adds, "...they make the fit 100x better."

Jevienne Biron - *Biotechnology Student*

When describing her style, Jevienne uses the words casual, formal and academic. Between balancing style and comfort she says "Sometimes, I'll wear

something I know will be uncomfortable, especially in the heat, because it's worth it when I like how the outfit comes together."

For her go-to outfit on busy days she says "Graphic tee, baggy jeans, sambas, a bunch of rings, a belt, and my carabiner with my keys and unique

accessories." Jevienne tends to dress based on her mood because when she plans in advance, it doesn't turn out how she imagined and adds "Spontaneous outfits somehow end up giving me the best style." She uses jewelry, a nice pair of shades and a belt to add a finishing touch to her looks.

Jevienne's fashion advice:

"Pick one thing that feels personal to you, like a color, a piece of jewelry, your makeup, shoes, or an accessory like my carabiner, and make it your signature. It's that little touch that makes you instantly recognizable in a crowd."



Trend Court:

The Wired Earphones Trial

In this session of trend court, we have the case Wired Earphones: Cool or Old-School?

Intesar: As someone who uses wired earphones, I'll be the defendant this time. I argue that wired earphones are cool, they are reliable and aesthetic.

Yassmin: I see your point but I still choose wireless, they are way more practical!

Intesar: Practicality isn't everything, wired earphones won't die on you mid-song. You're not caught up in charging or connection issues.

Yassmin: Yeah, but you're caught up in a tangled mess, whether it be in a pocket or a bag!

Intesar: I feel like that just adds to your personality. Plus, wired earphones are nostalgic, they give an instant 2000s vibe to everything.

Yassmin: I don't know, I'm still not convinced.

Intesar: Well, the evidence is hard to ignore. The results of our campus wide survey show that most students believe wired earphones are making a comeback.

Yassmin: Nostalgia is trending right now so I can see why wired earphones are becoming more popular.

Intesar: Well the jury has spoken and here is the final verdict: wired earphones are a timeless classic!

Nainka Towo - *International Relations Student*

The three words Nainka uses to describe her style are layering, '90s-inspired and loaded. She says she balances style and comfort by either choosing unique pieces that are comfortable on their own or regular clothes that can be layered and assembled to create a stylish outfit. For a busy day on campus, her go-to outfit consists of "black pants, a white shirt with either a pretty jacket or cardigan and some sneakers." Nainka always plans her outfits in advance and says "... at least for 20-30 mins the night before." She completes her looks by using jewels and jackets.



Nainka's fashion advice:

"You really need to dress according to your physical features whether it is your hair color, skin color, size of clothes, body type, makeup or just the haircut. Chose things that enhance your features and personality and not things that necessarily change them."

Want to be featured?

If you have noticed trends that simply cannot be missed or believe no one can out-dress you, then do not hesitate to reach out. Who knows? Your ideas or even you might end up intriguing our readers. Until then, keep your eyes sharp and your wardrobe sharper, because we definitely will be on the lookout.

MXenes: THE NEW PROMISE IN TACKLING “FOREVER CHEMICALS” AND MICROPLASTICS

November 1st 2025

By: Muniba Saeed



A new research review titled “Cutting-edge MXenes for emerging pollutants: From detection to elimination of PFAS, microplastics and nanoplastics” highlights how a new class of materials called MXenes, could revolutionize the way we detect and remove some of the world’s most persistent water pollutants.

The paper, authored by Dr. Ihsanullah, explores how MXenes are being used to address two of today’s toughest environmental challenges: the detection and removal of per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) and micro- and nanoplastics (MPs and NPs) from contaminated water.

What Makes MXenes Special?

MXenes are a new family of two-dimensional (2D) materials made of transition metals combined with carbon or nitrogen. They are known for their high surface area, strong conductivity, and customizable chemistry, which make them ideal candidates for environmental cleanup.

Because MXenes can be fine-tuned at the atomic level, scientists can engineer them for specific purposes such as filtering contaminants, capturing pollutants, or even detecting them with high sensitivity.

The Pollutants: PFAS, Microplastics, and Nanoplastics

PFAS, often called “forever chemicals,” are used in everyday products like nonstick cookware, firefighting foams, and waterproof coatings. They don’t easily break down and have been linked to serious health risks, even at trace levels.

Meanwhile, microplastics and nanoplastics—tiny fragments from larger plastic debris—are increasingly found in oceans, rivers, and even inside human bodies. Because of their small size and resistance to degradation, these pollutants are extremely difficult to detect and remove with traditional water treatment systems.

MXenes in Action: From Filters to Sensors

The review highlights several ways MXenes are being applied to tackle these pollutants:

- **Membranes for Filtration:** MXene-based membranes can filter PFAS and plastic particles more effectively than many traditional materials. Their tunable pore sizes and surface chemistry allow them to trap pollutants through physical sieving and chemical attraction.
- **Adsorption and Catalysis:** Engineered MXenes can adsorb large amounts of pollutants or even break them down chemically, using catalytic or electrochemical reactions to degrade harmful compounds.
- **Sensors:** MXene-based sensors can detect pollutants at extremely low concentrations—sometimes thousands of times more than conventional sensors. These could help monitor water quality in real time.

The Limitations

Despite their promise, MXene technologies are still in early stages. Most studies so far have been conducted in laboratories rather than real-world settings. Scaling up production is difficult because many synthesis methods use hazardous chemicals like hydrofluoric acid, raising safety and environmental concerns.

Researchers also need to study the long-term stability and environmental impact of MXenes themselves, including what happens when they degrade or are disposed of.

What’s Next?

The author emphasizes several priorities for future research:

- Developing greener and safer synthesis methods.
- Exploring new MXene compositions beyond titanium-based types.
- Conducting life-cycle and safety assessments to ensure environmental compatibility.
- Using artificial intelligence to design more efficient MXenes for specific pollutants.
- Bridging the gap between lab experiments and real-world applications.

Why It Matters

This review positions MXenes as one of the most promising materials for next-generation water purification technologies. Their combination of flexibility, reactivity, and multifunctionality makes them ideal for addressing pollutants that have so far resisted conventional cleanup methods.

However, the study also serves as a reminder that innovation must go hand in hand with sustainability. As the author notes, MXenes could become key tools in global water protection, only if scientists can overcome the challenges of safe, scalable production and responsible use.

CONVENIENCE CULTURE IS KILLING COMMUNITY

November 3rd 2025

By Haaniyah Memon

Face to face interaction is the core of human sociality. These face-to-face interactions that are being replaced by technologies to benefit us and bring ease to our lives are doing much more than that. Think about the last time you went to a grocery store instead of using Noon Foods, or the last time you chose to speak to a cashier rather than using the self-checkout kiosk. What once required effort and connection now only takes a click of a few buttons. In the era of today, we're given so many alternatives to make our lives easier, but along with speeding up and making processes much more convenient, they are taking away the interdependence and the bond that helps build social life and community.

If we compare today's society to that of 15 years ago, we can see a huge difference in what people perceive as comfort. We've gotten used to being on our own; when we think of comfort, we often see ourselves in our own bubbles away from uncertainty. Society's sense of comfort has shifted from a community-based to a more individual-based idea. According to psychotherapist and author Eloise Allexia, technology has continued to help us live isolated and sanitized lives, "moving us away from social spaces and in-person interactions, and towards our own private spaces".

We can attribute this shift to "needless niceties"; things that are nice to have but not necessarily well necessary. If you really think about it, these needless niceties serve the pockets of big corporations more than our own, making us buy convenience we didn't even need. Needless niceties could include Drive thrus, online shopping, self-checkout lanes, QR code menus & Open AI. All of these may reward you with more time but is also taking away the social aspect of day to day interactions, affecting your relationships in the long run.

In many ways, innovations have made life easier, opening up accessibility for those with disabilities, saving time for busy parents, and simplifying everyday tasks. Convenience can welcome relief. Yet when speed and effortlessness become the primary measures of value, something important slips away: the richness of life that comes from patience, struggle, and the slower rhythms of genuine human connection.

We've replaced the community with convenience. And in doing so, we've lost connection, support, and shared time." - Sneha Lodha

So how do we reconnect with others? Stop for a minute, think, and slow down. How will those extra minutes benefit you? Is the loss of your social life worth the extra hours in your day that you use to doom scroll? Maybe the obstacles you go through to get to the end aren't inconvenient but experiences. Maybe Inconvenience is the cost of community.

WHERE DID LITERACY GO? THE LOST ART OF READING FOR KNOWLEDGE

November 3rd 2025

By Haaniyah Memon

In the fast-paced world we live in today, where reading has become an escape from the real world, we can see the effects of constant communication and entertainment on how we perceive books.

The majority of readers think of romance, thriller, and fantasy when they hear the word books, and non-fics are getting lost in between the waves of escapes and imaginary worlds. People feel "overwhelmed" by what's happening around the world and the constant shower of information they intake on a daily basis from social media. This shows us the effects of bite-sized content. Rather than fully understanding each piece of information we see, we take in a headline and move on; not only does this affect our critical thinking, but also how we perceive the world.

Cultivation theory implies and emphasizes the effects of what we digest from the media and how it changes our perspective of the world. In simple terms, if you keep seeing negative content, you will see the world as a negative space. When applying this to the world we live in today, where all we intake is pieces of negative information without knowing or understanding their root causes and solutions, you can only imagine how this affects our mental states and burden we hold. Naturally, people turn towards an escape from reality, like books.

When books are seen only as an escape from reality, non-fiction essays are left behind in the shadows. The convenience of having entire encyclopedias and collections of history at the touch of a button is destroying the curiosity to open a book and see the world beyond bullet point facts.

So what's the solution to this? Like most problems in our lives, it's probably reducing your social media screen time or resetting your algo every now and then to make your feed less fast-paced. Bring back single-use media, turn on the TV for news, read substack articles for different P.O.V.s on similar issues, have intellectual conversations with friends, and lastly, read a non-fiction book!

THE NEW AGE OF ACTIVISM

November 3rd 2025

By Adam Ismail

Everyone is standing for a cause these days. The threshold for being called an activist has never been lower. A retweet or repost is often enough to earn social validation from your so-called activist friends — this is what passes for activism in the new age.

Is that a good or bad thing? I'll let you decide.

Back in the day, when people believed in a cause or witnessed injustice, it became their whole life. It consumed them. People risked their comfort, safety, and even their lives to stand for what they believed in. Nothing was performative back then — no one stood in the corner taking your Instagram photo while you held a sign that said "No more." It meant something to stand for something.

Protesting is a privilege. Having your voice heard, knowing your words matter, and believing you can bring about change — that is a privilege that should never be taken lightly.

Activism is not a phase. It's not cute, it's not quirky — it's a way of life.

Yes, war is bad and pollution is harmful. Anyone with a school education could tell you that. But announcing that you're "anti-war" or that you want to "save the planet" is simply not enough. Most people don't care what happens to others — their first thought is, "What does this do to me? How does it affect my life?" Humans are inherently selfish. So to care so deeply about a cause that you're willing to risk your livelihood, even your life, for it — that's something truly beautiful.

Activism, at its core, is beautiful. It's one of the rare times humans become selfless. Human life is sacred, and we should treat it as such. We've become so desensitized to the suffering and misery of others. We're told to believe there's a reason for everything, but there will never be justification for the wounding or killing of civilians.

After the 1950s, children asked their parents why they didn't stand up to the horrors of Nazi Germany. That question never goes away — it just changes with time. I hope that when the next generation asks us why we didn't do more, we won't have to say: "it was too political."

***"In the end, we will remember
not the words of our enemies,
but the silence of our friends."***

***- Martin Luther King Jr.,
(The Trumpet of Conscience,
1967)***

Moments & Memoirs

Moments & memoirs is a space dedicated to personal stories and reflections, where writers share snapshots of life that are meaningful, memorable, or transformative. This section highlights experiences that resonate on an emotional level, capturing the emotions, lessons, and memories that shape our everyday lives. It's a place for readers to connect with real-life moments through engaging, narrative storytelling.

MOMENTS AND MEMOIRS: CULTURE & EMPATHY THROUGH THE LENS OF A RENEGADE CHEF

November 3rd 2025

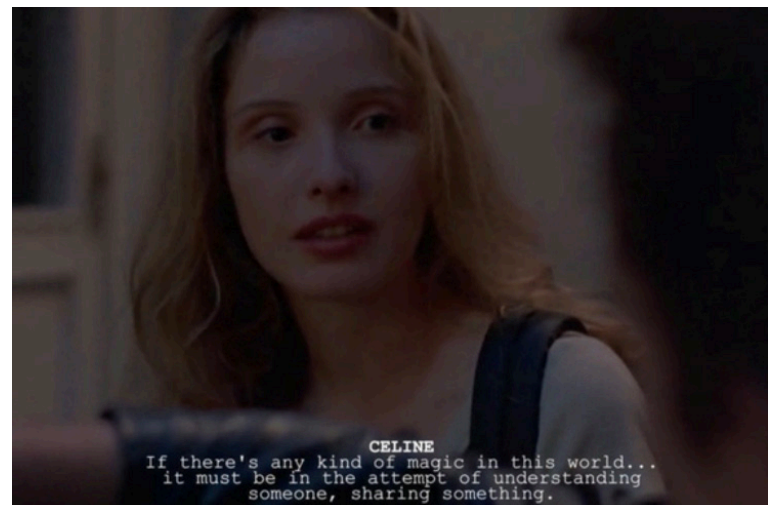
By Mustafa Abdallah Bin Adil

On my way to a seaport city off the Mediterranean coast in France during the summer of '24, I was just settling into 37E, helping myself to a pack of salted peanuts served on flights to tempt one into ordering a drink when I realized I was sandwiched between two very different people, a man dressed as if he was late for a business meeting occupied the window seat, blackout mask over his eyes and his seat reclined, it was apparent to me that he planned on snoozing for most of this seven hour flight. To my right, I noticed in the aisle seat, a man who seemed to be in his early twenties who every so often executed the same maneuver - craning his neck, eager to catch a sliver of the fleeting terrain beneath us. None of the A24 films available for viewing on the ten inch screens appealing to me, I became the unwilling hinge between two stark opposites occupying the seats next to me.



This ironic predicament served as the catalyst for this article, reminding me of something I'd read in a nomadic chef's memoirs - "traveling isn't reward for working, it's education for living". Anthony Bourdain was an American author, chef and host of multiple critically acclaimed TV series that weren't just about food, but about the people and stories behind them as well as the culture they represented. He started as a line cook in the underbelly of New York before making his way up to head chef at Brasserie Les Halles. His writing inspired me to look at the world through the lens of a traveler and not a tourist, made me want to break bread with strangers in an attempt to understand them. Thanks to him, I've often-times found myself sitting outside a bodega on a worn-out plastic chair underneath an awning surrounded by people whose lives are so different from mine and yet, somehow, similar. Through his documented life, Bourdain tried to instill in people the fact that travelling is a privilege not to be taken for granted. The festering lack of empathy we see today stems from a lack of experience, both lived and shared - we scroll past lives we haven't witnessed, often confusing observation for understanding. He experienced culture firsthand, dining with political charlatans as well as the children of war-torn

Palestine, aware that wisdom grows not in isolation, but in the messy and often uncomfortable exchange between people.



Before Sunrise, Dir. Richard Linklater, 1995

I am not totally ignorant of the fact that not everyone is privileged enough to travel and experience different walks of life first-hand, however this does not change the fact that a few thousand kilometers from here someone less geographically fortunate than us is subjected to injustice. While most of us may not possess the means to witness the world beyond our borders, we do all share in the ability and responsibility to educate ourselves.

"If I do have any advice for anybody, any final thought, if I'm an advocate for anything - It's to move, as far as you can & as much as you can. Across the ocean, or simply across the river, the extent to which you can walk in somebody else's shoes or at least eat their food, it's a plus for everybody" -Anthony Bourdain, on his show 'Parts Unknown'

MOMENTS AND MEMOIRS:

SOMEONE PLEASE POINT ME IN THE DIRECTION OF THE APPLE-APPLE STORE, THANK YOU!

November 3rd 2025

By Sarah Abdulsaeed

As a senior in university, I have always been told that entrepreneurship and innovation are two of the most important skills one must possess. Although, I've never been one to share my ideas because they are incredibly silly, and belong only in my mind that somehow runs a million miles an hour despite surviving on 3 hours of sleep, and 2-3 Americanos spaced exactly 4-5 hours between each other, I have been struck by an idea so silly I must share it.

On a Thursday evening enveloped by sorrow and bereavement, I said goodnight to my beloved Macbook Air that has weirdly become my comfort over the last ten years of my life. As it took its last breath trying to import footage onto Premier Pro, I held it, or at least tried to because my God that thing was HOT, and freaked out because I carelessly hadn't backed up a single one of my files. I realised I never imagined a day my laptop and I would part ways, and I would feel a genuine slight sadness that it was gone forever.

Is it weird to feel real human feelings for an inanimate object? 10 years is no small feat for a device that has had to bear the weight of Adobe Creative Cloud, all the legal (wink wink) movie streaming websites, the 50 browser tabs I no longer need, but refuse to close, and The Sims (which I totally 100% legally downloaded). My laptop that has been there for me through thick and thin, at 2 in the morning, 3 in the morning, 5 in the morning, you get the idea, my sleep schedule is a mess, and so is my laptop's.

I tried to trace back the memories of when I first received my beloved laptop, may it rest in peace, and in the process I realised that this isn't the only apple-related object I have a weird connection to. Well it isn't an apple-related object. It's just apples. I'm obsessed with apples. I guess you can say apples are apple-related...?

Anyways, I must not get off track, although that is one of the few things I excel at. As a kid, I was always fussy. Fussy sleeper, fussy eater, just a difficult child to raise and understand. No one ever really knew what I wanted, as all I did was whine and cry for a while, and then go to sleep.

Not too far off what I do now as a grown 21 year old woman, except sometimes the crying gets in the way of the sleeping, and

results in a good 3 hours of sleep right before a day of back-to-back classes starting at 8AM. Someone please remind me to fix my sleep schedule, I'll have to find a space for that thought in my bullet train of a brain though.

Let's get back on track. Or at least try to. A fussy kid. Annoying, loud, talkative, disruptive, sensitive, cry-baby. Again, quite similar to my current self. Whenever things did not go my way, I would burst into tears. I would cry for ages. Even when I got what I wanted, the tears kept running like a broken faucet. "Do you want a plushie?" "Do you want a hug?" "Do you want food?" "Juice?" "For God's sake what do you want?"

I did not know. I did not know what I wanted, or why I was still crying. "Too sensitive." I was told. "What a crybaby!" I heard.

The tears rolled down my cheeks for what seemed like the millionth time to my parents. Through my blurry eyes, I saw a round red object. An apple? The confusion stopped the crying, and I grabbed the shiny red apple from my father's hand and stared directly at it. So shiny.

Did you know they spray food-grade wax on fruits in supermarkets to make them look extra appetizing? They say it's to "preserve them by retaining moisture and protecting against decay." Yeah sure, whatever you say, corporate supermarket.

Back on track? I said I'll TRY to get back on track. Emphasis on TRY.

I bit into the big apple (Hey! I'm walkin' here!), and the crunchy sweetness momentarily takes over my brain. A tissue wipes my tears, and blows my nose. And I eat the apple to its core.

Is that why I felt real human sadness when my laptop's screen turned black forever? When I pressed each and every key, like a child messing with their parents' computer, hoping one of them would magically turn it back on? Is it that I am too sensitive? Too childish at my big age? that i can never take things seriously, and sometimes blurt out the stupidest string of

words that don't even make a coherent sentence?

I unplugged the charger, after finally accepting that the whole laptop died, not just the battery. I walked downstairs, into the kitchen, embarrassingly, with a few tears clouding my vision.

A big shiny red apple sat on the table by the oven. I bit into it, and giggled at how it resembled the Apple logo. Coincidence? I THINK NOT. An idea formed in my brain. An Apple-apple store. Yes, you heard me. (Can you actually hear me? Hello? Testing testing?) An Apple-apple store. I haven't come up with a name yet, and I believe you know exactly what two products we would offer. Oh, yes, you're a part of this now. We're taking this to Shark Tank! Five million dollars please!

I have said my final goodbyes to my beloved Macbook, and now I will bring us back on track. To be human is to feel – deeply, intensely, sincerely. Too sensitive? Maybe just empathetic. My brain may be wired differently, and I may be the only person who cries over their dead laptop, and believes they can sell Macbooks and apples in one store, but I've grown to accept that.

I've grown to accept, and love (or at least tolerate) the person who should fix their sleep schedule, close those 50 tabs she has left open for no reason, sometimes cries herself to sleep, and should probably eat less wax-covered food.

UOS DIGEST LAUNCHES THEIR SECOND ISSUE

October 3rd 2025
By Mira Fadi

The UOS Digest celebrated the release of its second issue, titled Press Culture, and International Podcast Day on September 30 at the College of Communication building in the University of Sharjah. The launch event attracted a large number of students from across the University, filling the atmosphere with excitement and curiosity.



Credit: Alya Al Ali

Attendees quickly filled the hall even before the event officially began. Followers of the magazine said they “had been looking forward to it for weeks,” enthusiastically anticipating the release of the awaited issue. Many gathered to grab a physical copy of the magazine, an experience that felt far more personal and engaging than a digital release. “It’s nice to actually get to hold it and flip through the pages,” shared a student. “We’ve gotten so used to reading digitally, so this is very refreshing,”

Five interactive booths were set up by the UOS Digest team. People were lining up, eager to participate and claim their rewards. These included a variety of fun and creative challenges such as Guess the Movie by the Outfit, Taylor Swift or Shakespeare, Safe or Poison, Guess n’ Sketch, and the Podcast Booth, offering different ways for attendees to engage. In celebration of International Podcast Day, the Podcast Booth encouraged participants to speak about assigned prompts as if they were in a real podcast recording. Those who managed to speak about their given topic for over two minutes received a prize, creating lively conversations and an interactive experience.

The Goya Café pop-up at the event encouraged attendees to get a quick drink while browsing the magazine. Additionally, a photo booth was set up, giving students the chance to pose for memorable photos with friends, the magazine team, and copies of the new issue. Free food and beverages were also provided, allowing attendees to snack as they moved between booths, adding to the welcoming and engaging atmosphere of the launch.

Mini-interviews with attendees allowed them to share their favorite articles and thoughts about the magazine’s content. Many praised it for its wide range of topics. “I love the whole magazine, especially the diversity of topics,” said an attendee.



Credit: Alya Al Ali

“It’s so interesting to read about so many different things, from climate change to fashion. You students really did a great job.” The team also conducted their signature This or That interview, a fan-favorite segment from the magazine that everyone always waits to participate in.

The main goal of the event was to promote the UOS Digest and create an environment for people to grab the new issue, discuss it, and meet the team who brought it to life, and it certainly achieved its goal and beyond. The event attracted a wide range of students and faculty members who supported the student-led publication the team worked very hard on and celebrated its growing success. By the end of the day, the magazine rack was completely empty, with every copy of the UOS Digest claimed.

THE LOST ART OF...

By Yassmin and Intesar Mohammed Khalil

From decades, to centuries and across eras, time flows, changing and replacing whatever doesn't fit anymore. We call it *progress*, and eagerly accept all the new things that come with it, which is normal as there's no harm in welcoming change. But what about the things we've misplaced in between? The things that have disappeared quietly, unbeknownst to us. The Lost Art is a space that takes a closer look at things that have faded over time and what their disappearance means for us. A small reminder that *progress* doesn't always mean good things, and that the past usually has something to teach the present.

Whispering

Think about the last time you whispered, and no, not just lowered your voice, *whispered*. It's different, it's about speaking softly, leaning in closer because what you are saying is not for everyone. Whispering is much deeper than just volume, it's about *intention*.

Today we can't escape noise, even during lectures, students don't whisper anymore, most of the time it sounds like public speaking, but seated. But it's not just lecture halls, it's also cafés, libraries and much more.

We don't just talk loudly, we live loudly as well. Sharing,

posting and announcing everything we do leaving no room for quiet and meaningful exchanges.

When did everyone's volume knob become permanently turned up? When did the ability to keep a moment small and private vanish? Somewhere in the middle of modernism. Is whispering too

old-fashioned for today's world? Does it not fit in anymore? Maybe, it's because we live in a world where to be noticed you need to be loud, whether it is online or offline.

Whispering asks for invisibility, it doesn't need an audience, a concept we might have forgotten. It also means

respect for the space you are in and for the people around you. Its disappearance marks not just the fading of a sound but also the quiet joy of experiencing something that belongs entirely, to the present moment.

And maybe that's why we need it back. It reminds us that somethings are meant to be shared softly, and sometimes it's okay to talk to just someone, not everyone.



Source: Pinterest

Third Spaces

Once upon a time, we had playgrounds, or in other words our *first* third space. An informal space where we could just simply exist, free of plans. Now, the closest thing we have to that is the cafeteria, in which friendships depend on who's available between classes.

We need playgrounds again, not the kind with swings and slides, but the kind with Wi-Fi where we can sit for hours, question our major, and watch the day go by without feeling guilty. Somewhere between home and campus, a third space where our presence doesn't need a purpose, password, or a coffee purchase.

University has all the basics covered: lecture halls for learning, libraries for focus, and cafés or cafeterias for

caffeine-fueled socializing. And at home we're sleeping, snacking, or pretending to be productive, but what about somewhere in between? The spaces that aren't home, work, or class.

Those neutral spots, the in-between spaces where we could just be, have simply vanished. We don't wander around, stumble upon friends, or claim random corners just to talk anymore. Instead, group chats, video calls, and endless scrolls are the new third spaces.

These digital replacements have become the hub for those spontaneous conversations, bursts of laughter, and

harmless mischief that used to fill the gaps between classes and although efficient they encourage surface-level connections. They lack a certain charm.

Source: Pinterest



We have perfected the art of being together without ever being in the same place.

The simple joy of claiming a spot on random benches or shaded patches of grass

for no reason at all has disappeared.

Perhaps adulthood tricked us into believing that we have outgrown playgrounds. But subconsciously, we miss sitting around and talking about nothing, calling it *plans*.

Hobbies

When we were kids, our hobbies existed solely to help us pass time, today they play a different role and it is seen as an achievement to have one.

Somewhere between childhood and university, hobbies stopped being everyday things and elevated to the status of *rare little treasures*. If someone mentions that they play the guitar or paint in their free time, it is no longer just casual information, rather, it is considered as something pretty impressive, almost surprising even.

Our younger selves jumped into hobbies without thinking too much about them. We drew random doodles in our notebooks, tried different origami folds that resembled disaster in the end, or learned random skills, because, why not? Even if these activities took patience, focus, or practice, we did not mind. We thought the reward was simply in doing it, not for getting a grade or even praises.

Now, those very hobbies seem almost exotic. Somewhere along the lines, we created this misguided idea that we must be Vincent Van Gogh to pick up a paint brush or Gordon Ramsey to get into cooking. Suddenly, everyone's too scared to be bad at anything.

Hobbies now have starter packs and aesthetic expectations. You can't just start drawing, you need to have the *right* markers. You can't just simply knit, you need *organic* fibers. Even journaling looks like a full-time design project.

When did hobbies switch from being fun to becoming a financial investment? It's as if having a hobby carries a certain prestige since very few people

take the time to do them nowadays.

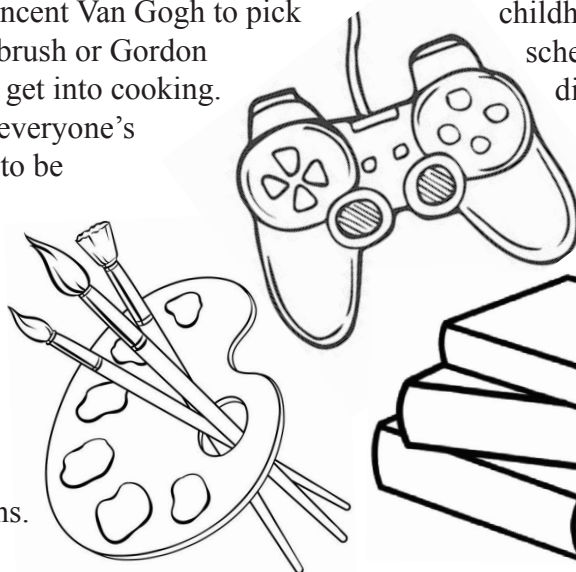
Our free, playful exploration in childhood has given way to schedules, deadlines, and digital distractions making a small accomplishment of learning a song or finishing a sketch stand out in the

middle of it all.

With this in mind would it be dramatic

to assume that students are most likely to become experts at procrastination rather than at knitting or drawing?

Maybe it's time to reverse hobbies to their original purpose, a fun way to pass time. In the busy, chaotic life of a student, seeing someone getting lost in a hobby serves as a reminder that there is more to life than deadlines and screens.



Source: Pinterest

Boredom

Are we still capable of being bored? Not the boredom we feel when we are standing in a long line and scrolling on our phones, but real boredom. The kind that is uncomfortable and makes you realize how slow time can pass. The kind where you have nothing to distract you and you're left alone with your thoughts. Most of us haven't, at least not in recent times. We've successfully erased the existence of boredom itself, eliminating and filling every gap with some kind of digital distraction.

Think about when you were younger. What did it mean to be bored? As a child being bored which was usually connected with summer holidays was something that was

unavoidable. Everyone at some point either created new games, or passed time by balancing random things, or even took part in some kind of imaginative play. But at the end of it we survived and those hours that felt like they would never end taught us something valuable: ideas can grow from stillness.

What about now that we're older? Where did boredom go? Maybe, it isn't something that quietly disappeared on its own. By filling every empty space, we left it with nowhere to live.

Being bored and doing nothing are commonly misconceived as being lazy or wasting time. But that's not true. It's only because we live in a world

that is so busy we assume that stillness equals unproductivity, when it really

means restoration. Letting your mind wander allows you to enter a space where you remember things you've forgotten or uncover parts of yourself you've hidden. By doing nothing you actually end up doing everything. You intentionally create a state in which your brain can rest and move its focus from outward to inward.

Relearning this lost art means bringing back silence in our lives and by doing so we actually reconnect with the world. It's usually in these pauses the best and creative ideas appear, like letting your mind wander on a bus ride, or tracing patterns on a ceiling when you're laying down, or even when you're doodling in the margins of your notebook. It's when we notice things we normally wouldn't.

So maybe it's time to stop demonizing boredom and find the beauty in it. By letting ourselves be bored on purpose, we might just realize it was never the enemy, rather it is a form of therapy. A quiet portal that stretches time and give us back our lives. Boredom should be welcomed not escaped from.



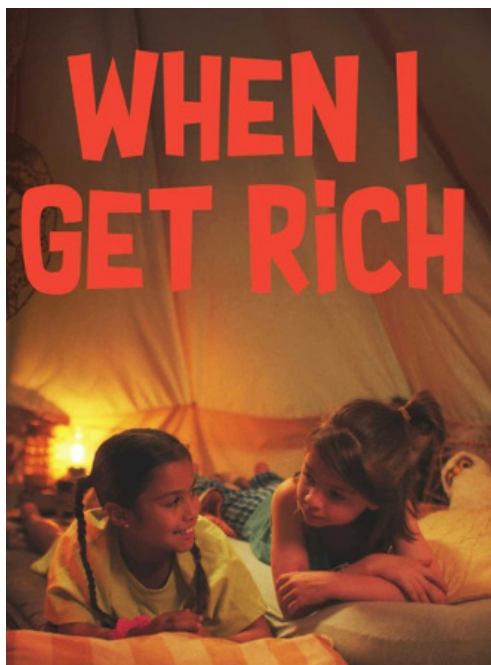
Source: Pinterest

THE SHARJAH INTERNATIONAL FILM FESTIVAL TAKES OVER CINEMAS ACROSS THE COUNTRY!

October 11th 2025
By: Batool Maher

The Sharjah International Film Festival is a festival that was first launched in 2013 and consists of films for Children and Youth, under the FUNN establishment, an organization that is government run by Sharjah under the patronage of Her Highness Sheikha Jawaher Al Qasimi.

The festival is dedicated to enhancing media literacy for children as media is becoming a huge role in everyday life, it also helps foster children's and youth's creativity and showcase the very best of filmmaking.



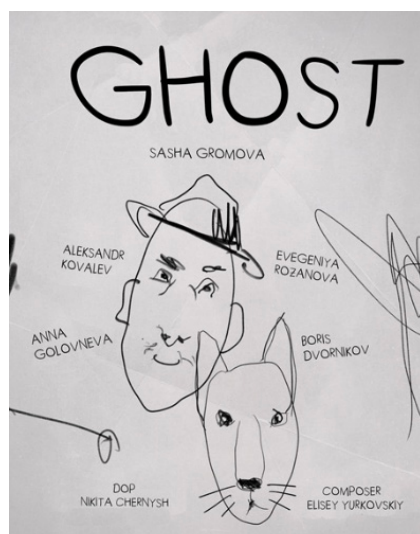
Credit: SIFF

struggles and songs of the UAE's pearl divers. Most of these had the same theme of heritage, friendship and human resilience. Highlighting the UAE's culture and diversity.

SIFF plays a main, essential role in bringing international films for children in the region, enabling them to a world of cultures and promoting peace. During the festival, there is a Q & A panels to discuss the movies with the filmmakers, workshops for different sides of the filmmaking field and child-made or teenage-made films screened.

This October, it swept cinemas across the nation as they played films from SIFF from 6 October to 12 October, these films consisted of short animation, short Arabic films and short international films, all ranging from 70 to 135 minutes.

Some notable titles are "When I get Rich" where a boy and a girl forge an unlikely friendship, "Ghost" following a tender journey between a granddaughter and his mentally ill grandfather, and "Oh Yamal", reviving the



Credit: SIFF

Some of the workshops offered are 3D printing, photography & videography and editing for a cinematic look, all offered for ages 12 and above, enabling kids to understand the filmmaking world from such a young age.



Credit: SIFF

The discussion panels featured Emirati filmmakers like Fatima Alshamsi, Abdullah Al Ali and Ali Fouad who discussed their experiences in local and international cinema, some challenges they might have faced and how cultural context shaped their work.

Another interesting discussion panel that was available was "Psychology of Film on Children & Youth", featuring guests like Filip Hillesland, who is a director, Mohammed Alsalami, a director of the Media Monitoring and Content Services Department at the UAE Media Council, and Dr. Leena Amiri, a consultant Child and Adolescent Psychiatrist and Assistant Professor at the United Arab Emirates University. This panel discussed how films can affect the children and youth.

The film festival is an important marker in the city's history and culture as it amplifies youth directors, giving them a career stepping stone, and introduces kids to a whole world of culture and film that is celebrated for the years to come. If you missed out on it this year, make sure to catch it next year and immerse yourself into the city's festivals.

CAMPUS GOES PINK FOR BREAST CANCER AWARENESS MONTH

October 11th 2025

By: Nour Nader

Our campus recently transformed for an event of unity, creativity, and compassion for Breast Cancer Awareness Day. The sounds of buzzing throughout campus from students to faculty who united for a day of fun and meaningful activities for an incredible cause.

From stations of playful games and breast cancer-themed challenges to arts and crafts areas, wellness classes, and educational booths, every corner of the event conveyed a powerful, positive message. Health educators and volunteers shared important information about early detection, self-examination, and the importance of regular screenings—empowering everyone to take breast health seriously.

Students engaged with the bracelet crafting booths, photo stations, and bake sales while raising awareness and championing the power of unity. It was an entertaining and educational atmosphere that promoted inquiry into breast health in a fun way.

Pink ribbons and educational flyers were handed out by volunteers as departments joined forces to transform the campus with awareness quotes and colorful cut-outs. Laughter and a strong sense of unity ran through the air as everyone fostered their participation in things both enjoyable and meaningful.

The day concluded with a group photo capturing the collective spirit of love, awareness, and unity. It served as a powerful reminder that small acts of participation, generosity, and attention can make a lasting difference in supporting a life-saving cause like breast cancer awareness.

MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS EVENT HOLDS POSITIVE ENERGY

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21ST EDITION OF THE INTERNATIONAL EDUCATIONS SHOW IN SHARJAH DRAWS OVER 30,000 VISITORS

October 23rd 2025

By: Leen Moufleh

Organised by Expo Centre Sharjah in partnership with the Sharjah Chamber of Commerce & Industry (SCCI), the Sharjah Private Education Authority (SPEA) and the Ministry of Higher Education & Scientific Research UAE (MoHESR), the event featured more than 100 universities and accommodated more than 30,000 individuals from over 16 countries.

Participating countries included the United Kingdom, Spain, Germany, Hungary, the United States, Georgia, Malaysia and India. Local UAE universities



Credit: Expo Center Sharjah News

such as United Arab Emirates University (UAEU), Khalifa University, Zayed University, American University of Sharjah (AUS), and University of Sharjah (UoS) also had prominent representation.

The Exhibition offered visitors a wide spectrum of academic programmes—from undergraduate degrees to specialist post-graduate courses—across disciplines such as medicine, engineering, business administration, information technology, and emerging sectors like artificial intelligence and cybersecurity

Beyond course listings, the event also featured:

- Expert-led workshops and seminars on admission criteria, scholarships and future skills.
- EdTech showcases and smart learning solutions from global education-technology providers.
- Dedicated time slots for female and male students: Wednesday (08:00-14:00) for female students, Thursday (08:00-14:00) for male students, and Friday & Saturday (15:00-21:00) open to families.

According to Saif Mohammed Al Midfa, CEO of Expo Centre Sharjah, the IES “reflects Sharjah’s strategic commitment to advancing innovation-based sectors through targeted investment in quality education.” The event positions Sharjah as a hub where global educational institutions meet regional students, helping to align academic decisions with future labour-market demands.

Representatives from universities reported high traffic at their booths and lively engagement with students who came prepared with questions about courses, fees, scholarships and global study destinations. Organisers emphasised that this kind of direct interaction is what sets the show apart.

A parent visiting the show commented:

“It’s been invaluable to speak face-to-face with universities from different countries and compare options in one place.”



Credit: Expo Center Sharjah News

With this edition recorded as one of the largest to date, stakeholders expect future shows to further integrate emerging technologies, vocational pathways and augmented reality learning experiences. Plans are already underway to deepen collaboration with regional training institutes and increase support for students from under-represented backgrounds.

The success of the IES signals that the demand for international higher-education access remains strong in the UAE and the broader Gulf region.

THE GENIUS OF KENDRICK LAMAR

November 10th 2025

By: Reem Siralkhatim

Kendrick Lamar is not only a rapper — he is a very good narrator and a community voice. Kendrick, who was born and raised in Compton, California, was surrounded by the genius and the miseries of life in that place. His music usually portrays the true picture of that place — the agony, the hope, and the power that children draw from the hard life. He had been writing and speaking through words since childhood. This love eventually led him to be one of the most influential musicians of the time. Kendrick began to attract attention in the early 2010s with his mixtapes, alongside which his talent for transforming real-life experiences into powerful lyrics was shown.

His debut studio album, *good kid, m.A.A.d city* (2012), portrayed the life of a teen facing crime and the pressure of trying to be good in Compton. The album was very honest, it had the rawest emotions, and it drew deeply from the artist's life. It proved that rap was not only about money and fame, it could also relate to and tell meaningful stories that people lived through.

“The best way to describe myself is that I’m a real person. I go through real situations”

Kendrick's release of his strikingly different-to-most-rap-albums-then, *To Pimp a Butterfly*, in 2015, was one of the highlights of his career. Although it did not resonate with the majority of rap albums at the time, it was quite artistic. It did not confine itself to mere beats and catchy hooks, but rather dipped into jazz, funk, and soul sounds throughout. Lyrically, the content revolved around racism, self-love, success, and the hardships that accompany the aforementioned.

While tracks like “Alright” turned to be migrating symbols of hope and power, others like “u” made visible the singer's more sensitive side. The album was not only acclaimed but also won and nominated for awards, however it sparked controversies being the case.

To Pimp a Butterfly was met with some criticism which claimed it to be too political or too abstract. Their arguments were that the album was not for the average listener and that Kendrick had completely moved out of the zone of mainstream hip-hop. On the other hand, this argument was widely accepted by a considerable number of fans and critics as being the main reason why the album was so unique. Kendrick was not looking to be accepted — rather, he was out to unveil the truth and to provoke people's thought through his art.

Kendrick, however, has kept on advancing in his artistic evolution since then already. His newer works such as *The Big Steppers* and *Mr. Morale & The Big Steppers* reveal a talent for blending heavy themes with catchy sounds. Kendrick Lamar has shown the quality of rap being intellectually stimulating, emotionally expressive, and impactful all at the same time. He narrates a story through his music that is of importance — not only to him but also to every listener.

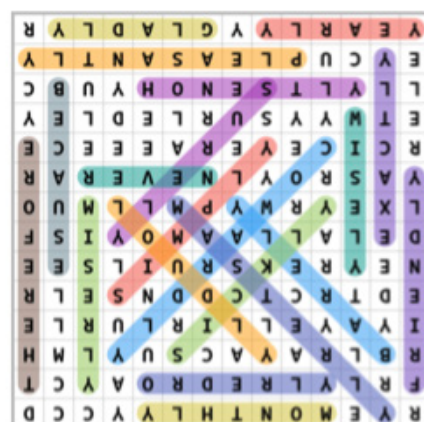
KENDRICK
LAMAR



Wordsearch of The Month: *Adverbs*

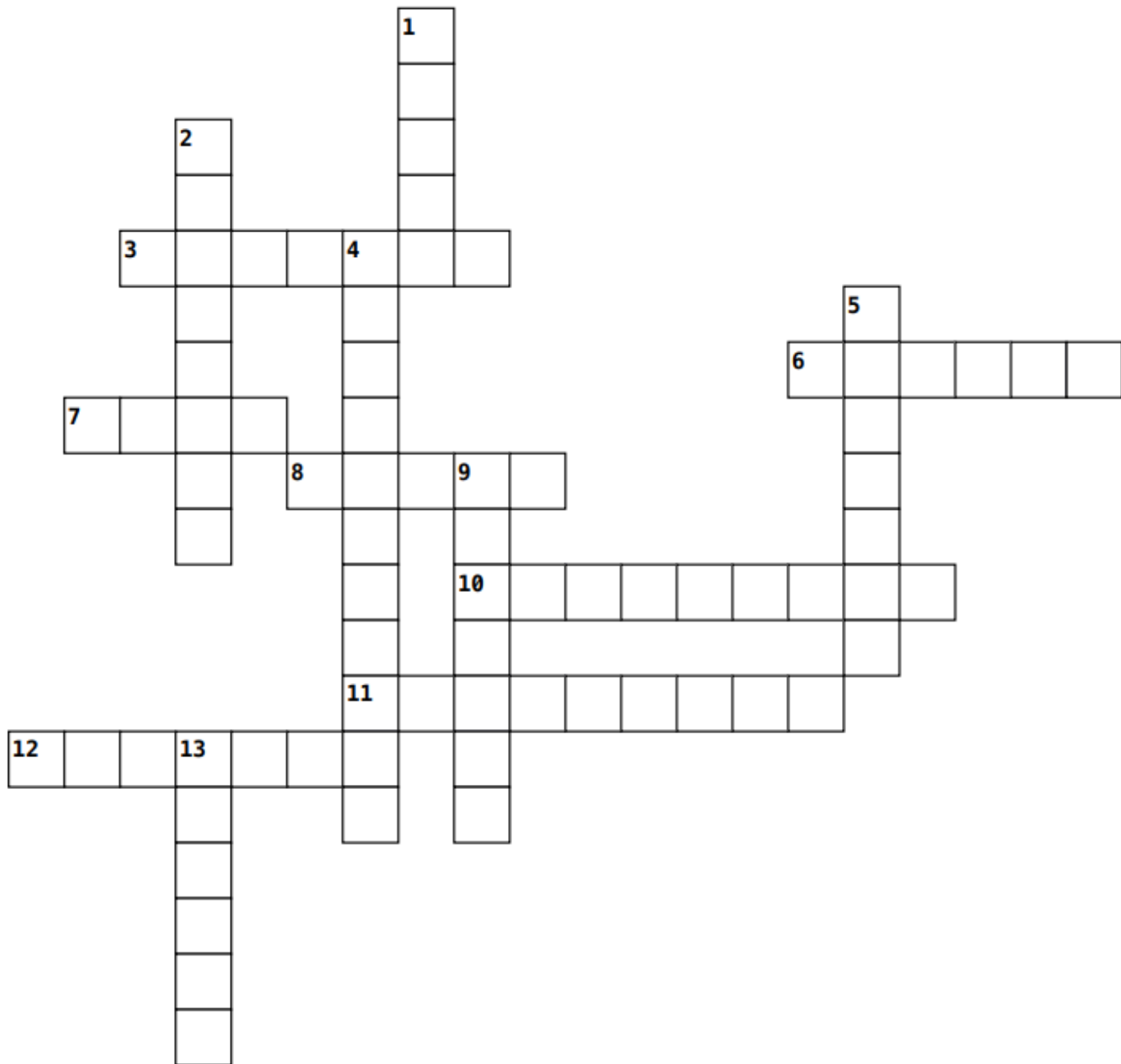
MISERLY
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F	R	L	Y	L	R	E	D	R	O	A	Y	C	T
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R	C	I	C	E	Y	E	R	A	E	E	E	C	E
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L	L	Y	L	T	S	E	N	O	H	Y	U	B	C
E	Y	C	U	P	L	E	A	S	A	N	T	L	Y
Y	E	A	R	L	Y	Y	G	L	A	D	L	Y	R



Crossword of The Month:

Mother Nature

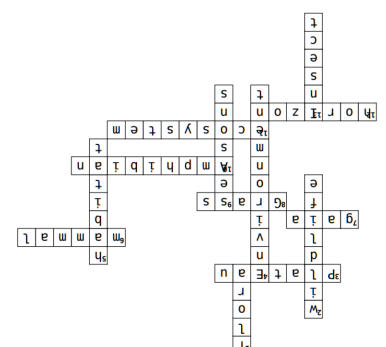


Across

3. Geographic feature that rises sharply above surrounding terrain but has a flat summit.
6. Warm-blooded animal with hair or fur.
7. Mother Nature in Greek mythology
8. Greenery that covers lawns.
10. Cold-blooded animal that lives both in water and on land.
11. System where plants, animals, and environment coexist.
12. The line in the distance that separates earth from sky.

Down

1. Plant life found in a particular area.
2. Creatures that live freely in their natural habitats.
4. The natural world around us.
5. Natural environment where a species lives.
9. Spring, summer, autumn, and winter.
13. Tiny animal with three body parts and wings.



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